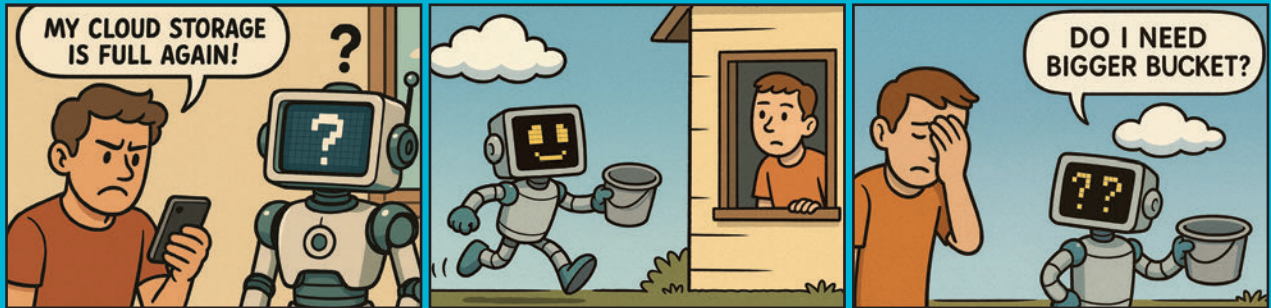


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AI is radically going to change how people use PCs: Dell's Jason Durst

Dell's betting on practical intelligence and AI that works invisibly

—By Yashraj Verma

Buying a new PC can be a real headache. Being a laptop reviewer, I've been through it, staring at a wall of specs, trying to figure out what's what. Now that AI PCs are a thing, it's tougher than ever. It turns out, I'm not alone. Dell recently discovered through an external source that a whopping 74% of people get confused during their PC-buying journey.

I recently sat down with Jason Durst, Vice President, Consumer PCs & OS Products, Dell Technologies to talk about this problem and how they're tackling it. Our chat focused on three key things – the new nomenclature, AI PCs and their adoption rate. The conversation was a refreshing reminder that the best technology isn't about flashy specs but about making our lives easier.

The 74% problem

Behind Dell's recent product lineup revamp lies a statistic. Durst mentioned during the interaction that

according to Deloitte research, 74% of PC buyers get confused during their purchasing journey. This either forces them to buy the wrong PC for them, or simply stopping them from buying a PC altogether. This became a call to action that's reshaping how Dell thinks, especially now that thin and light AI PCs are a thing.

"When we hear the word simplification, it's really about customers," Durst explains Dell's move from the XPS branding to the more straightforward "Dell Premium" nomenclature. "People are trying to navigate the technology environment, and there are a lot of choices today. It's a bit confusing", which I totally agree.

AI that's not just artificial

Ask brand folks about AI PCs, and you'll be greeted with fancy buzzwords and specs. Ask Jason, and he pulls out his Lunar Lake XPS 13 like a boss.

"The battery life is absolutely bar none, surpassing anything produced previously. The multi and single thread performance made another step function jump. The graphics capability is just

astounding," he mentioned. "If you put those pieces together on their own, independently of anything to do with AI, you could do more than you ever have on your PC". This is refreshingly a great step in an industry obsessed with artificial intelligence theatre, by letting the product do the talk.

While Durst can't share specific adoption numbers, his observations paint a picture of rapid market evolution thanks to the new AI normal. "The initial response to an AI PC when they first came out on the market was that people were wondering what are these things. The people who are interested in buying them have shown incredible growth."

When I forced Jason to choose between performance and AI-focused PCs, he said, "You don't have to give it up." His daily driver proves the point: an XPS 13 that handles graphics work while delivering multi-day battery life.

As our conversation concludes, it was quite clear that in a market saturated with AI promises, Dell's bet on practical intelligence and AI that works invisibly to solve real problems, might make a lot of sense to a lot of consumers. **d**